was writing “Two Dogmas,” and he was very impressed with Quine’s arguments. Quine’s paper “had a considerable impact on me because I was wrestling already with the problem of meaning,” Kuhn said later. Kuhn had first become interested in the history and philosophy of science while he was a graduate student studying solid-state physics. He had been roped into being a teaching assistant for a new course in the history of science, and he ended up reading Aristotle’s *Physics.* There, Kuhn encountered a strange world, one where heavy things fell because they were supposedly trying to return to their “natural place” at the center of the universe—the Earth. “What Aristotle could be saying baffled me at first, until—and I remember the point vividly—I suddenly broke in and found a way to understand it, a way which made Aristotle’s philosophy make sense,” Kuhn recalled. He abruptly found himself looking at the product of a first-rate mind at work, struggling to understand the physical world around him, just like a modern scientist. The key difference, Kuhn realized, was that Aristotle was starting from an entirely different worldview. Within that worldview, Aristotle’s ideas made a great deal of sense. Kuhn came to believe that the whole picture he had of the progress of science, a cartoonish picture he’d picked up from his coursework as a physicist-in-training, was simply wrong. Science didn’t progress by simply piling one victorious theory upon another. It was far more complex and subtle than that.

Once Kuhn had finished his PhD in 1949, he switched fields entirely, becoming a historian and philosopher of science. After spending several years researching the history of physics, especially the period around the Copernican revolution, he set out to expound his new view of science, which ran counter to the positivist conception of scientific progress. Ironically, he was given the perfect opportunity to do so by the positivists themselves. Charles Morris, the American positivist who had helped Carnap come to America, approached Kuhn and asked him to contribute a monograph on the history of science to the *International Encyclopedia of Unified Science,* still limping along after Neurath had started it over twenty years earlier. Morris had tried to find someone to write this monograph for several years, to no avail; his working title for it was *The Structure of Scientific Revolutions.*

Despite its appearance in Neurath’s encyclopedia, Kuhn’s book expounded a view that was totally at odds with positivist ideas about